

Profile

Personal information

Name Ahmed, Syed Abdullah
Share different name No
Birthdate 08/24/2004

Contact details

Email, Phone abduallahm24@gmail.com, +92.3054533783, Mobile,
+92.3004368066, Mobile
Permanent address 291, Street 36 Block S, Phase 2 DHA, Lahore, Punjab, 54792, PAK

Demographics

Gender Identity Male
Sex Male
Pronouns He/Him
Military status None
Hispanic or Latino/a/x No
Race Asian (Pakistan)

Language

English First Language, Speak, Read, Write, Spoken at Home
Urdu First Language, Speak, Read, Write, Spoken at Home

Geography and nationality

Citizenship status Citizen of non-U.S. country
Birthplace Lahore, Pakistan 0 years US
Other citizenships Pakistan
Current US Visa None

Common App fee waiver

Fee waiver requested

No

Family

Household

Parents	Married
Home	Both Parents

Parent 1

Father

Name	Dr. Qasim Ahmed
Email, Phone	qahmed62@hotmail.com, +92.3004368066, Mobile
Occupation	Physician, Employed, Fatima Memorial Hospital College of Medicine & Dentistry, Lahore, Punjab, Pakistan
Education	Graduate school Other (1978), Government College, Lahore, Punjab, Pakistan Medicine (1985), King Edward Medical College, Lahore, Punjab, Pakistan

Parent 2

Mother

Name	Mrs. Syma Q Ahmed (Nasseer)
Email, Phone	ahmedsyma@hotmail.com, +92.3004364038, Mobile
Education	Graduated from college/university Bachelors (1990), Kinnaird College, Lahore, Punjab, Pakistan

Siblings

Syed Asad Ahmed, Age 30
Khadija Ahmed, Age 29

Education

Current or most recent secondary school

**Aitchison College, Shara Quaid E-Azam, Lahore, PAK, Independent, CEEB: 690220
(08/2017 - 08/2023)**

Boarding school	Yes: Not living at school
Progression	No change in progression
Graduation Date	08/2023

Colleges & universities

Grades

Rank	na / 300
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Current or most recent year courses

Full year

COMPSCI - Computer Science - (Cambridge AICE AS A-Level)

MATH - Mathamatics - (Cambridge AICE AS A-Level)

PHYS - Physics - (Cambridge AICE AS A-Level)

Honors

Duke of Edinburgh - Bronze Medalist	International	10
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IGCSE Certificate of Merit & Academic Blazer	School	11
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Ranked 1st in competition, Computer Science - Kangaroo National Competition 2021	State/Regional, National	11
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Outstanding Diplomacy - Model United Nations, Millennium International 2021	International	11
1st place in Geometry and Math Proofs - Sigma 2022, Lahore University of Mathematics and Sciences	National	11

Future plans

Computer programmer or analyst, Masters

Testing

SAT tests

Evidence-based Reading and Writing	660	10/01/2022
Math	720	10/01/2022
Taken	1	
Planned	0	
SAT Essay	No	

Activities

Community Service (Volunteer)

10, 11, 12

Year

6 hr/wk, 48 wk/yr

Continue

CEO & Co-Founder, Rozgari

Founder of a non-profit aiming to connect users & jobseekers i.e. barbers, electricians, electrician. Launched to mitigate the effects of COVID.

Internship

11

Break

40 hr/wk, 6 wk/yr

Continue

Intern & Programmer, Arbisoft - Software Company

Programmed & developed CRM software using Python. Enhanced CS skill set by engaging in various tasks. Worked alongside seasoned programmers.

Computer/Technology

11

Break

25 hr/wk, 3 wk/yr

Continue

Programmer & Developer, Gaming Project with CS Professor at University of Texas, Austin

Developed and recreated Wordle on Python. Worked with team members on the project. Mentored by professor of Computer Science.

Research

12

School, Break

7 hr/wk, 10 wk/yr

Continue

Research Associate, AI & Machine Learning Research - Professor at Virginia Tech

Performed assigned tasks, researched college level AI & machine learning project. Prof Ali R. Butt mentored to ensure research goals are aligned.

Other Club/Activity

10, 11, 12

School

5 hr/wk, 40 wk/yr

Continue

Member, General Secretary - 12th grade, Aitchison Computer Science Society

Compete and lead school team in multiple national CS competitions. Supervise 50+ society members, manage teams at events. Develop & organize projects.

Athletics: JV/Varsity

9, 10, 11, 12
School
10 hr/wk, 40 wk/yr
Continue

Cricket, Team member - All-Rounder, Aitchison College Cricket Team
Play fixtures against Pakistan's Int. Women's Team. Compete against rival schools.

Community Service (Volunteer)

9
Break
25 hr/wk, 4 wk/yr
Continue

Mentor & Teacher, Care Foundation
Taught a class of 30 students, age 10-14, math, geo & eng. Mentored unprivileged children on social issues. Participated alongside in sports.

Community Service (Volunteer)

11
Break
25 hr/wk, 2 wk/yr

Group Leader & Volunteer, Hope Uplift Foundation
Mentored students at the orphanage. Organized fundraisers & food drives. Assisted with vocational training. Managed inventory at dispensary.

Debate/Speech

10, 11
School
6 hr/wk, 25 wk/yr

Committee Director, Member, Aitchison College Model United Nations (ACMUN), Society
Organized National Level MUN event ACMUN. Competed in inter-school MUNs, won best delegation, outstanding diplomacy. Public speaking skills enhanced.

Other Club/Activity

11, 12
School
6 hr/wk, 25 wk/yr
Continue

Member, Director of IT , Aitchison College Science Society, Aitchison College Science & Engineering Concept Event (ACSEC)
Compete in mult inter-school Sci Olympiads. Won best-school award. Develop the website, supervise event tech. Manage the IT team. @@@ participants.

Writing

Personal essay

Some students have a background, identity, interest, or talent that is so meaningful they believe their application would be incomplete without it. If this sounds like you, then please share your story.

There I was; with a smile on my face, playing cards with my family. Until that smile changed to a state of shock. I stared at my grandfather, unable to understand what he was saying. He was stuttering, mumbling as his face dropped towards one side, having a stroke. He was rushed to the hospital, and I was left dismayed on the eve of my first day of school in Pakistan. This is the reason why we moved to Pakistan from Singapore. My father wanted to take care of his parents, a commitment to family and community, the same values which were instilled in me.

Growing up in Singapore had a profound impact. Singapore is a multicultural country, celebrating every religion's holiday from Hari Riya, Diwali to Christmas, Chinese New Year and Vesak. Being such a diverse place, I was able to meet people from all around the world in my international school. It opened up my mind and gave me a new perspective on life. It made me respectful of people's opinions, new cultures, and heritage. Having made friends from Australia, England, Spain, Southeast Asia, Israel and India I learned a great deal about each culture. Meeting people from different backgrounds made me understand that their country or religion didn't define them, instead, it's the personality that one connects with. Pakistan and India have political tensions, whereas my best friend growing up was from India. In contrast, Pakistan at times is a culturally exclusive society. Many sects of religion and caste have been created, with resentment towards one another that makes me question why these problems exist in the first place. For society to prosper all must be accepting of each other.

During the school year, a very regular day, coming home to see my father watching the news shook me. I couldn't believe what I was seeing. A hotel manager, from Sri Lanka, had been attacked by a mob. They brutally tortured him, lynching him, which led to his death. All because he supposedly said something 'blasphemous'. Even if the allegations were true, the reaction, the cruel action taken by a mob was totally unjustified and shameful. Going to school the next day, the incident had people talking. I felt obligated to do something about it, and hence I decided to create awareness among my peers and my juniors in school. Having discussions in class and break, and holding a camp after-school, I wanted to make sure that they understood that the tragic event that had occurred was prejudiced and by no means justified by any reasoning. That we must be open to others' thoughts and having a difference of opinion brings out our own uniqueness. A month later, religious sects were arguing which resulted in violence breaking out. Sunnis and Shias have deep resentment for each other, quarreling that one is right and the other is wrong, heating up, resulting in fights amongst them. I couldn't understand this. Why? Why is there such resentment towards one another? Having lived in the diverse society of Singapore, where everyone respected each other and a peaceful environment had been created, the country and people were able to prosper.

I have been chosen multiple times in Singapore and Pakistan as a 'pair buddy' to help get new students settled in. I remembered my first days at a new school and country. I always started conversations with students asking them about their favorite sport, movies (being a sports and film enthusiast), making an effort to make others feel welcome and at home. Today, I remain engaged with my community and school clubs, where we continue to discuss and speak of tolerance and inclusion. The lessons I take from my parents, community, and family, plus my international upbringing have taught me to embrace challenges with a growth mindset, and a value set of immersion in community.

Additional information

From a young age, I've been passionate about computer science and technology. I can still remember my grade six CS teacher telling my father *"I'd be surprised if he didn't end up pursuing this field in the future"*. My introduction in grade 7 to HTML and Scratch, creating a version of the game Mario, I fell in love with programming. The idea of creating, solving, and continuous phases of trial and error became inscribed in me. I was mentored at Arbisoft, a tech company founded by a Stanford alum, which further enhanced my programming skills by developing corporate projects on Python using object-oriented programming. The internship gave me insight into how a software company functions, the latest technological advancement, and confirmed my pursuit for technology. I reached out to international professors from the University of Texas – Austin and Virginia Tech. My friend and I worked with the professor at Texas, he gave us a task to re-create Wordle on Python. With the professor at VirginiaTech, I was able to research and practice concepts of machine learning and AI.

When Covid-19 first hit, it was unexpected. In the beginning, I never fully understood its severity. When the second wave came, canceling exams and closing down schools, I felt motivated to take an initiative. Due to covid many people in the community were facing difficulties; businesses being closed down, the country's economy being hurt, resulting in inflation at extraordinary levels. In the search for normality, I called the barber to find out how I can get a haircut since the shop was closed. Given the shutdown, he had moved on to home service only. He discussed the difficulties he faced having fewer clients; finding it difficult to send his kids to school and the challenge of keeping up with increasing prices. The same issues were faced by the electrician. They had a common issue *'kaam nahi mil raha (there is no work)'*. I was driven and wanted to contribute with my skill set, so I turned to CS. Creating a non-profit platform, connecting clients with skilled workers.

I called up my friends and told them about my idea. At first, they were a bit hesitant, stating that we are only 16-year-olds, 'how can we do this?' But after making them understand the impact that we could have, they were all on board. Rozgari was born. From thereon, we started our work, researching, and developing the website. We sought out help from our teachers, and with the skills that we had developed, we created a website; <http://www.rozgari.pk>. We bought a domain from GoDaddy, along with an SSL certificate, so that our website was secure and could be trusted. We integrated APIs and plug-ins, understanding that the people may not have access to the internet, we created an SMS system; where at the time of booking a mobile message is sent to job seekers. The prospective employee receives a message by the user, with their contact number,

address and booking time. My friends and I made sure to keep it simple while developing an admin panel and interface. We used Cpanel for the management of our database and website.

When I shared my idea with the barber about the project, he was more than willing to use our platform. We received the same support when we shared the initiative with others. At the time of launch, we shared posts and videos through social media and WhatsApp groups, trying to get as much outreach as possible. At first, progress was slow, however with time we got regular users, using our platform to receive services. The public response was great, with users praising us for our work and effort. It gave a sense of joy and fulfillment as many were able to find work again. In the midst of a pandemic, the business cycle continued.

Education progression

Details

Education progression details No change in progression

PREVIEW

Courses & Grades

Courses & Grades not completed

I understand that some colleges that require Courses & Grades may view my application as incomplete.

Purdue University questions

General

Entry Term	Fall 2023
Round	Early Action
Do you intend to pursue merit-based scholarships?	Yes
Do you plan to send Purdue test scores?"	No
Purdue Fee Waiver	I do not qualify for any of these options
Scholarship, award, or prize	Yes

Academics

College, School, or Program	College of Science
Campus	Main Campus - West Lafayette
Major/Program of Study-First Choice	Computer Science (Fall Only)
If we cannot admit you to your first choice major, would you like to be considered for a second choice?	Yes, I want to select a second-choice major
College, School, or Program - Second Choice	School of Management
Campus	Main Campus - West Lafayette
Major/Program of Study-Second Choice	Business Analytics & Information Management (Pre)
Pre-Professional Studies Interest	None

Activities

Favorite Activity/Experience

The opportunity to do an internship at Arbisoft, a renowned tech company, during the summer enhanced my drive to learn more about computer science. A 9-5 schedule immersed me in the CS world, where I saw programmers taking care of everyday tasks. I was given my own workstation, working alongside senior developers that mentored me to further strengthen my Python proficiency. I was entrusted with managing part of the CRM dashboard, where the company could monitor its sales activities with a clear UI/UX interface. I was given independence with routine checks within the development team.

I was assigned to the backend team working on the project EDITED. A business intelligence program that helps retailers drive a better outcome through AI-driven market and enterprise intelligence. By taking in data and connecting it with business analytics. Watching and learning from my mentors gave me insight and knowledge about data analytics and its benefits. At Arbisoft I learned about supportive corporate culture. During the summer, Pakistan produces the best seasonal mangoes. An event took place which brought everyone together called Mangofest. A theme of yellow went around the office with smiles, laughter, and mangoes. This made an impression on me, a strong hard work ethic was present, at the same time the company made sure that there was a work-life balance. Having table tennis tournaments, a gym and other events in addition to being mentored by experienced programmers made me understand to always have a balanced lifestyle.

Contacts

Previously Applied	No
Contact 1	Website
Consent to mobile/text contact	I consent to be contacted by Purdue University at the mobile phone number provided below
Mobile Phone Number:	+92.3004364038

Family

Sibling applied	No
Is relative in list	No
Based on the parent/guardian information you listed in the Family section of the Common App, do you have any parents or guardians who live in a known address different than your own?	No

Residency

Do you have a parent who lives in Indiana who provides financial support? No

Do you believe you may qualify for in-state tuition? No

Writing

Why Purdue?

Purdue's curriculum will allow me to pursue my ambitions for CS related entrepreneurship. Entrepreneurs-in-Residence (EIRs) are people from whom I look forward to learning from. What stood out to me was the discovery park at Purdue which encourages research projects and collaborative innovation. Purdue having multiple club options, such as robotics and the 3D prosthetics club will allow me to further develop/ input my skills in a productive manner. Intramural Sports is an activity I look forward to building bonds with peers and playing sports given my cricket background.

Why Major?

I've had this fascination for technology, the idea of solving a problem, going through the process of trial and error has its own sense of satisfaction and accomplishment. I believe that technology is the key to solving most problems of the world. It is helping in the fight against climate change, has made communication easier, shortening travel time, ease of life through AI, etc. My goal is to address some of these challenges. As the General Secretary of my school's Computer Society, I have had the opportunity to mentor and teach Python. Through CS I plan on building impactful applications.

Briefly discuss your reasons for pursuing the second choice major you have selected. (Respond in 100 words or fewer.)

Entrepreneurship has been part of my resolve. Doing research with professors from UT Austin and VirginiaTech, I was able to see behind the scenes R&D work before it goes to market. At Arbisoft I saw them work towards user development, working for consumer needs, and then working towards a product/software. Creating in order to monetize. I learnt that in order to be a successful entrepreneur one needs to have a good product understanding plus gauge consumer needs. Putting together R&D work with consumer requirements makes tech entrepreneurship successful.

Honors College

Honors College Interest? No

Affirmations

By submitting this application, I affirm my understanding of and agreement to the statements found here: <http://www.commonapp.org/affirmations>.

PREVIEW